

Google+ celebrity accounts

For publicity, Google's social networking site Google+ has started a verified account system similar to what Twitter offers

Running a 'live' system

Most Linux distributions allow for a 'live' system, where you can test the entire operating system off a CD or a USB drive, without making any changes to your hard drive!

Open Source in India

Operating System

Solutions) Linux, a Debian-based Linux distribution, which included support for all major Indian languages, as well

as tools and applications (such as fonts, translators and spellcheckers). It was primarily intended for desktop use by governments aiming to ease the transition from the proprietary Microsoft Windows to GNU/Linux. However, two variants, called EduBOSS and BOSS Advanced Server were also released subsequently, which modified the original software to suit the requirements of school students and servers, respectively. This was one of the major deliverables of the NRCFOSS. Developers stated that over the long term, the BOSS Linux project would "attempt to be the standard GNU/Linux distribution for desktop computers in India". BOSS Linux is currently at version 4.0, and can be downloaded from <http://bosslinux.in/>.

While supporting Indian languages certainly widens the user-base, Dhvani, a



Karunakar Guntupalli

"FREE" AND "OPEN SOURCE" SOFTWARE

While referring to FOSS, one may be led to believe that "Free" and "Open Source" are synonyms that refer to the same software model.

There is, however, a subtle but important difference between the two. The difference lies mainly in their ideologies: Proponents of 'Free Software' (The Free Software Foundation (FSF) founded by Richard Stallman) believe that software should inherently give users the right to change, modify and redistribute the software without restriction. They believe in the concept of software being something akin to a 'right', and the freedom to use it as per one's will follows naturally. 'Open Source' on the other hand, is a more practical description of software, and believes that by making the source code available to users, the software can be improved upon. In other words, according to the Open Source model, it's easier to improve software by keeping it open-sourced rather than proprietary. Frederick Noronha, an independent Goa-based journalist and an Open Source enthusiast puts it very succinctly when he says that "...the whole emphasis is different. Open Source builds its argument on the basis of efficiency. Free Software, on ethics."

It's worthwhile to mention here that both concepts are very different from the term 'Freeware', which simply refers to software that is free of cost, without commenting on the freedom it offers, or the ability to modify / redistribute it.



Frederick Noronha

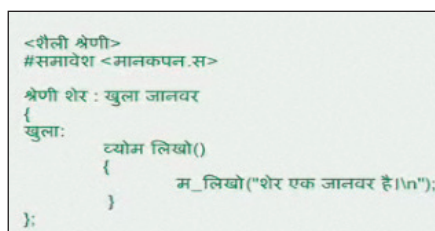
India Awards in 2008, Dhvani aimed at making computers available to everyone, not just the literate masses. If Dhvani and many more projects were aimed at spreading the use of computers in general, "Hindawi", a software project which grabbed the first place at the FOSS India Awards 2008, aimed to make computer programming and software development available to the masses. Hindawi allows for programming in native tongues using equivalents of popular programming environments like C, C++, BASIC, Assembly Language, Lex etc. and equips students to learn concepts ranging from those taught at the primary school level to advanced ones like robotics and super-computing.

Another prominent Open Source venture from India is GNUKhata by

the Comet Media Foundation. It aims to motivate and help businesses who are contemplating switching to free software. It's a free accounting and inventory management software that uses Postgresql as its database server and is licensed under GPLv3. It is currently undergoing development to make it compliant with any RDBMS such as MySQL and SQLite.

Government Policy

In 2009, the Maharashtra State Government signed a MoU with Microsoft to increase computer literacy as well as provide e-governance solutions in the state. The MoU included the setting up of three academies in Maharashtra at Nagpur, Aurangabad and Pune, to train approximately 90,000 school teachers and familiarise them with the use of computers.



Opensource story in India

text to speech (TTS) conversion software for Indian languages, took it a step further. Winning the third place at the FOSS



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